The Flood and Babel

Genesis 6–9 · Genesis 11:1–9

The big idea: The earth filled with violence and God sent a flood, but Noah found favor, and grace came first. God made a covenant and set his bow in the cloud. At Babel people tried to make a name for themselves, and Jesus' blood speaks a better word than Abel's.

Before you meet: Read

Genesis 6:5–22 | Genesis 8:20–9:17 | Genesis 11:1–9

Open (5 minutes)

Have you ever been rescued from something you could not get out of on your own? What happened?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"But Noah found _____ in the eyes of the LORD." *(Genesis 6:8)*

"I have set my _____ in the cloud, and it shall be a sign of the _____ between me and the earth." *(Genesis 9:13)*

At Babel they said, "Come, let us build ourselves a city and a tower with its top in the heavens, and let us make a _____ for ourselves." *(Genesis 11:4)*

Discuss

1. "Noah found favor" comes before "Noah was a righteous man." Why does that order matter? *Genesis 6:8–9*

2. The flood washed the earth but not the human heart. What does that tell us about what we really need? *Genesis 8:21*

3. At Babel, people tried to make a name for themselves. Where do you see that same drive today, in our culture or in yourself? *Genesis 11:4–9*

4. Abel's blood cried out for justice. Jesus' blood "speaks a better word than the blood of Abel." What better word do you need to hear from him this week? *Hebrews 12:24*

Memory verse

"But Noah found favor in the eyes of the LORD."

Genesis 6:8

Pray

Thank God that grace comes first, that he keeps his promises, and that Jesus is the one door to safety. Ask him to help you forgive as you have been forgiven.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 10

The Flood and Babel

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Genesis 6:5–22 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the three fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Genesis 12 and 15).

Main points to land

1. Grace comes first. Noah found favor before he is called righteous, and he was saved by faith (Genesis 6:8–9; Hebrews 11:7).
2. The flood did not change the human heart (Genesis 8:21). We need more than a fresh start. We need a new heart and a Savior.
3. Jesus answers these chapters: his blood speaks a better word than Abel's, he is the one door to safety, he multiplies forgiveness where Lamech multiplied revenge, and at Pentecost he began gathering the scattered nations.

Core doctrine to teach

God's Justice and Mercy CORE DOCTRINE 5 OF 26

God is perfectly just. He does not overlook evil, and sin brings real judgment, as the flood shows. He is also rich in mercy. He saved Noah and his family, set his bow in the sky, and patiently holds back judgment so that people may turn to him.

Genesis 6:5–8; 9:8–17; Exodus 34:6–7; 2 Peter 3:9

Answer key (Observe)

1. favor
2. bow; covenant
3. name

Questions people will ask

Did the flood cover the whole earth?

The plain reading, which this study follows, is a global flood (Genesis 7:19). Some Christians who hold firmly to Scripture read it as vast but regional, since the whole earth sometimes means the whole known world (Genesis 41:57). Either way, it was a real judgment in real history, and Jesus treated it as a preview of the final judgment (Matthew 24:37–39).

Closing prayer

Father, we see ourselves in Cain's anger, Lamech's score-keeping, and Babel's pride. Thank you that your mercy has always run ahead of our sin, that grace came first for Noah, and that it comes first for us. Thank you for Jesus, whose blood speaks a better word than Abel's. Bring each of us in through the one door while it is open. Amen.